Resilience Academy

SDI Training for ICT Professionals

Form Design in KoboToolbox

Building Survey Forms with Drag and Drop

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Day 3 | 30 Minutes Lecture | crd.resilienceacademy.ac.tz

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The Form Builder: Visual, No Coding Required

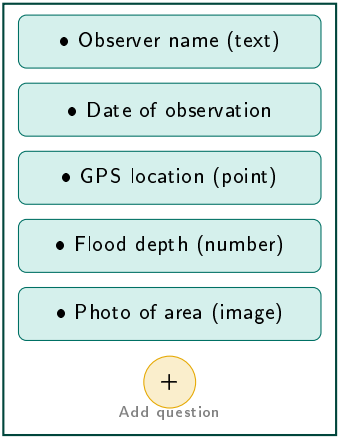
Drag-and-Drop Form Design

KoboToolbox has a built-in **visual form builder** that works entirely in your web browser. You do not need Excel, XLSForm, or any programming skills.

How to start:

1. Log in to KoboToolbox
2. Click the blue **"NEW"** button
3. Select **"Build from scratch"**
4. Give your form a name
5. Start adding questions by clicking the "+" button

Form Builder



Question Types You Will Use

Type	What It Does	Example
Text	Free text answer	"Enter observer name"
Number	Numeric answer only	"Water depth in cm"
Date	Calendar date picker	"Date of observation"
GPS Location	Records latitude/longitude from phone	"Mark flood location"
Photo	Takes a photo with phone camera	"Photo of flooded area"
Select One	Choose one option from a list	

Building the Tanga Flood Survey Form

We will build this form together. It has 8 questions:

1. **Observer Name** *(Text)*
   Who is collecting this data?
2. **Date of Observation** *(Date)*
   When was the observation made?
3. **GPS Location** *(Point)*
   Where exactly is this flood point?
4. **Ward Name** *(Select One)*
   Which ward in Tanga?
5. **Flood Depth (cm)** *(Number)*
   Estimated water depth
6. **Flood Severity** *(Select One)*
   Low / Medium / High / Severe
7. **Damage Types** *(Select Multiple)*
   Roads / Buildings / Crops / Utilities
8. **Photo** *(Image)*
   Take a photo of the flooded area

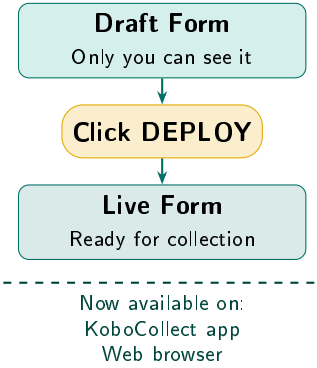
In the Practical Session

You will add each question one by one using the visual form builder. The instructor will show

Deploying Your Form: One Click

What Does "Deploy" Mean?

Deploying makes your form **available for data collection**. Before deployment, the form is a draft that nobody can fill in. After deployment, field workers can download it to their phones.



How to deploy:

1. Open your form in KoboToolbox
2. Click the **"DEPLOY"** button (top right)
3. Confirm by clicking **"Deploy"** in the popup
4. Done – the form is now live

After deployment:

Testing: Submit from Browser, View in Data Table

Always test your form before sending field workers out!

Step 1: Submit a test entry

1. Open your deployed form
2. Click the **"Open"** button (web form)
3. Fill in all the questions with test data
4. For GPS: click "Get Location" (uses your computer's location, or enter manually)
5. Click **"Submit"** at the bottom

Step 2: View the submission

1. Go back to your form's **Data** tab
2. Click **"Table"** to see all submissions

What to check:

- ✓ All questions appear in the right order
- ✓ Required fields are marked with a red star
- ✓ Select options show the correct choices
- ✓ GPS location is captured
- ✓ Photo upload works
- ✓ Submission appears in the data table
- ✓ GPS point shows on the map view

Useful Tips: Skip Logic, Required Fields, Default Values

Required Fields

- Click a question in the form builder
- Toggle **"Required"** to ON
- The field worker *must* answer this question before submitting
- Use for: GPS location, observer name, date

Skip Logic

- Show or hide questions based on previous answers
- Example: Only ask "Describe building damage" if "Damage Types" includes "Buildings"
- Click a question → **"Skip Logic"** tab
- Set the condition using dropdown menus

Default Values

- Pre-fill a question with a value
- Example: Set today's date as the default for "Date of Observation"
- Click a question → **"Settings"** tab
- Enter the default value
- Saves time in the field

Summary: Ready to Build Your Form

What You Learned

- The form builder is **visual** – no coding, no Excel files
- Seven question types cover most field surveys: text, number, date, GPS, photo, select one, select multiple
- **GPS Location** is the key question type that makes your data spatial
- **Deploy** makes your form available for collection with one click
- Always **test** your form before real fieldwork

In the Practical Session You Will

1. Create a new form in KoboToolbox
2. Add the 8 questions for the Tanga Flood Survey
3. Set required fields and default values
4. Deploy the form
5. Submit 3 test entries using the web form
6. View your submissions in the data table
7. See your GPS points on the map view